REGIONAL BUSINESS WIRE

Industrial Equipment Distributor Announces Regional Expansion

COLUMBUS, Ohio, June 4, 2026 - By Karen Suttles, Staff Writer

A regional distributor of material-handling equipment said Wednesday it will open two additional service centers in the Midwest by the end of the year, citing steady demand from warehousing and logistics customers expanding capacity ahead of the peak shipping season.

The company, which distributes forklifts, pallet racking and warehouse automation equipment for several original equipment manufacturers, said the new locations will add approximately 40 positions combined, split between technician and warehouse roles. Company executives said the expansion reflects continued growth in e-commerce fulfillment demand across the region, even as broader industrial equipment orders have been mixed nationally.

"We're seeing our logistics customers plan for capacity a year or more out, which gives us confidence to invest ahead of that demand," the company's regional vice president said in a statement. The company did not disclose the specific capital cost of the expansion.

Industry trade groups have reported that warehouse automation spending has continued to grow at a mid-single-digit pace nationally even as new warehouse construction starts have slowed from the elevated levels seen several years ago, as operators prioritize retrofitting existing facilities over new construction given persistently high commercial construction costs.

The company said it expects the new service centers to be operational by the fourth quarter, pending final permitting in both jurisdictions.

The expansion comes as third-party logistics providers in the region continue to report healthy leasing activity for mid-size distribution space, according to a regional commercial real estate brokerage that tracks the market. The brokerage's most recent quarterly report found vacancy rates for distribution space under 200,000 square feet had tightened for a third consecutive quarter, even as vacancy in larger big-box distribution space remained elevated relative to its pre-pandemic level.

A regional economic development official said the two new service centers were the latest in a string of smaller industrial-services announcements in the corridor over the past year, though she noted the pace of announcements remained well below the levels seen during the warehouse construction boom several years earlier. "We're seeing steadier, smaller commitments rather than the mega-projects we saw a few years back," she said.

Analysts who cover the material-handling equipment distribution industry have generally described demand as stable but not accelerating, with replacement and maintenance business providing a steadier revenue base than new-equipment sales tied to warehouse construction starts. One industry analyst, who was not speaking specifically about the company in this article, said equipment distributors with a strong service and parts business have generally weathered the recent slowdown in new warehouse construction better than distributors more heavily weighted toward new-equipment sales.

The company, which was founded in the region more than three decades ago and operates a network of service centers across several Midwestern states, said it has grown its technician headcount by roughly a third over the past five years, a pace it said it expects to continue given current demand trends. The company is privately held and does not disclose annual revenue.

Company executives said hiring for the two new locations would begin this summer, with an emphasis on candidates from local technical and community college programs. The company said it has partnered with two regional community colleges on a technician apprenticeship program over the past two years as part of a broader effort to build a pipeline of qualified service technicians in a labor market where experienced material-handling technicians remain in short supply nationally.

The announcement did not include a change to the company's ownership or leadership structure. The company's president, who took over day-to-day operations from the founding family several years ago, said the firm remains focused on organic growth in its existing footprint rather than acquisitions for the foreseeable future.

A spokesperson for the company said the two new locations bring its total service-center count in the region to eleven, and that the firm expects to evaluate further expansion opportunities in neighboring states over the next 18 to 24 months, contingent on continued demand from its logistics and warehousing customer base.